

ST. BAITHIN'S MASSES

Emergency Number
087 3443600

26 th Sept	Saturday	6pm	Edward, Frances & Peggy Duffy RIP
27 th Sept	Sunday	12.15pm	Pro-Populo
29 th Sept	Tuesday		No Mass
30 th Sept	Wednesday	9.30am	Mass
01 st Oct	Thursday	7pm	Mass
02 nd Oct	Friday	7pm	Maura Lynch & Deceased members of Lynch and O'Donnell Families.
03 rd Oct	Saturday	6pm	Mass
04 th Oct	Sunday	12.15pm	Eddie & Rosaleen Carlin RIP

Sacrament of Confession: St. Baithin's each Saturday from 4.30 – 5.30pm.

NEWTOWNCUNNINGHAM MASSES

26 th Sept	Saturday	7.30pm	Brendan & Mary Cullen RIP
27 th Sept	Sunday	11am	Alex & Sarah Baxter RIP
29 th Sept	Tuesday	7pm	Patrick Glackin RIP
30 th Sept	Wednesday	9.30am	Mass
01 st Oct	Thursday	9.30am	Mass
03 rd Oct	Saturday	10am	First Saturday Mass
03 rd Oct	Saturday	7.30pm	Kathleen & Daniel O'Donnell RIP
04 th Oct	Sunday	11am	Eddie Friel RIP

KILLEA MASSES

27 th Sept	Sunday	9.30am	Mass
02 nd Oct	Friday	9.30am	Mass
04 th Oct	Sunday	9.30am	Pro Populo

Sacrament of Confession: All Saints Newtown every Saturday 10.30am – 11.30am.

Anniversaries: We pray for the souls of Paul Dillon RIP and Deirdre Dillon RIP. May their souls and the souls of all the faithful, departed rest in peace.

WEEKLY NEWSLETTER

27th September 2026 – Twenty-Sixth Sunday of Ordinary Time

Fr Philip Kemmy, PP
Office Address: Parochial House, Main Street, Newtowncunningham
074 9156138

STEP BY STEP THROUGH THE MASS

The Liturgy of the Eucharist (Part 9)

The small ritual that the priest carries out, whereby he washes his hands is called the Lavabo. The priest accompanies this ritual action with a short prayer which he speaks almost inaudibly: “**Wash me, O Lord, from my iniquity and cleanse me from my sin.**” As the water is poured over his fingers, the priest quietly recites these words, which are taken directly from Psalm 51 and are also an allusion to Psalm 26: “With the pure in heart I will wash my hands clean, and take my place among them at thy altar, there making thy praises known, telling the story of all thy wonderful deeds.” In fact, in the Old Rite prior to the New Rite of Mass 50+ years ago, the words of Psalm 26 accompanied this Lavabo Ritual. The Lavabo action and words (both in Old Rite and New) reinforce the fact that this action is not about physical hygiene, but about being pure in heart and holy in soul – treating the Holy Things of God in a holy way and with holy fear of the Lord. It is in some way akin to a last little examination of conscience for the priest before he advances any further in the offering of Holy Mass on the Altar.

In the Old Testament Temple times the priests in the Temple would wash their hands in a large bronze receptacle – a ritual which always preceded the act of sacrificing to God – which usually entailed the sacrificing of lambs and other animals. In the Book of Exodus (Exodus 30:17–21), God instructs Moses to make a bronze basin so that Aaron and the other priests could wash their hands and feet before entering the presence of God and offering sacrifice. These Old Testament Priests carried out this washing ritual before their essential task of handling and offering earthly sacrifices in the earthly temple. The Priest at Mass, therefore, handles the Heavenly Sacrifice of the Lamb of God, offered in this Church building but spiritually offered before the Face of the Father on High. The Lavabo ritual marks the transition from the presentation of the offertory gifts to the Eucharistic Prayer whereby the Holy Sacrifice of the Mass reaches its fulfilment. If a Jewish man or woman saw a priest washing his hands or feet, they immediately were alerted that a Sacrifice to God was about to take place. When we see the priest at Mass carrying out the Lavabo Rite then we too are reminded that the Holy Sacrifice of the Mass is about to enter its pivot phase.

After this ritual the priest addresses the Congregation with the words: “**Pray, brothers and sisters, that my sacrifice and yours may be acceptable to God, the Almighty Father.**” At first this seems like a slightly odd way of wording this exhortation, which is traditionally called the Orates Fratres (Pray Brethren). Next week we will look at these words and the reasons behind the strange turn of phrase: “my sacrifice and yours”.

Parish of Newtowncunningham & Killea

Email: office@newtownkilleaparish.ie
Website: www.newtownkilleaparish.ie

Sunday Collections: €1775. Thank you for your continued generosity to your Parish.

Eucharistic Adoration: takes place on Wednesday in Newtown from 11am – 8pm and in Killea from 2pm – 6pm on Friday.

First Saturday Rosary, Meditation and Mass: Next Saturday begins with Meditation at 9.15am, Rosary at 9.30am, Mass at 10am.

Fr Damien will visit the housebound sick of his area in **Newtown** on **Thursday** of this week.

Fr Philip will visit the housebound sick in Newtown area on Thursday as usual. He will visit those in the **Killea Area on Wednesday Morning** rather than Friday.

Parish of Taughboyne, St. Baithin's

Email: stbaithins@yahoo.com

Sunday Collections: €1485; **Development Fund:** €40; **Feast of the Assumption:** €20. Thank you for your continued generosity to your Parish.

Eucharistic Adoration in St. Baithin's this Thursday from **1pm – 6pm**. New Adorers are welcome and encouraged to commit to any of these hours.

Adoration and Holy Rosary, led by Fr. Damien on Thursdays from 6pm until 7pm in St. Baithin's Church. Come and pray for our community. Everyone welcome.

Fr Damien will visit the housebound sick in **Carrigans/St. Johnston** areas on **Friday** of this week.

Items for the Parish Newsletter must be submitted to the Parish office no later than 12 Noon on a Thursday to be considered for the Newsletter

ATTENTION CHOIRS/CHURCH SINGERS & MUSICIANS: Booking Form for the Diocesan Music Seminar on the 10th of October in the Mount Errigal Hotel are available in the Sacristy.

A COFFEE MORNING in aid of **Parish Youth Ministry** will take place on Friday 2nd October in Seomra Phadraig, All Saints, Newtowncunningham from 10am – 1pm. Please come along and join us for a cuppa and a 'wee' cake to support the faith formation work we do with our OGS Youth Group. **Everyone welcome.**

ANNUAL PARISH(ES) PILGRIMAGE TO MEDJUGORJE: Our 2027 Parish Pilgrimage will be flying out of Derry City Airport on Wednesday 14th April for 7 nights. If you are interested in taking a place on this pilgrimage, then please text your name and the number of places you will require to 087 9823261 in the coming days. Places are limited and priority will be given to those who are residents of both the Parish of St. Johnston and the Parish of Newtown and Killea.

DONEGAL HOSPICE ANNUAL REMEMBRANCE SERVICE for all those who passed away in the care of Donegal Hospice, Community Hospitals, Home Care Team or in the care of the Palliative Care team in Letterkenny Community Hospital will take place in Conwal & Leck Church of Ireland, Letterkenny **this Sunday afternoon** at 3pm. All are welcome.

A **PARISH ALPHA SERIES** begins **Wednesday 7th October at 7.30pm in St. Johnston Family Resource Centre.**

Alpha is a 7 sessions series that explores topics around God, faith and the bigger questions in life. Feel free to drop into the sessions – at least come and see the first week, then you can decide whether you would like to continue. Alpha is suitable for those with strong faith, weak faith or even no faith at all. We would love to have you join us as we explore the big realities of life and God with you. All are welcome. For more information or to come and see the first week it would be helpful though not essential to text your name and the word ALPHA to 087 3443600. This will help us know what to prepare with regards to refreshments on the first evening.